HR Practices of Al-Karam

This Capstone Project report is submitted to the Faculty of Management, Business Administration & Commerce

In Spring 2026

as partial fulfillment of

Bachelor of Business Administration/Bachelor of Science in Accounting and Finance

by

Uzair Ahmed Rajput (BUS-22S-185)

Ali Akbar (BUS-22S-143)

Ahmed Raza Soomro BUS-22S-141)

Muhammad Fardeen (BUS-22S-155)

Huzaifa Ahmed (BUS-22S-147)

Supervised by

Sir Shahid Obaid

Department of Business Administration/Department of Accounting, Banking & Finance

SINDH MADRESSATUL ISLAM UNIVERSITY, KARACHI

Table of Content

Abstract

Introduction

Literature review

Project Approach and Information Sources

Results and Analysis

Discussion

Conclusion

Recommendations

References

Abstract

The report is entirely based on HR department of Alkaram which identifies the challenges, issues and possible solutions associated with recruitment process, employee attrition, influencing stakeholder, hiring expenses and employee satisfaction. A very important aspect of this study is to analyze the way in which Alkaram handles their workers and to find the problems that are faced by their human resource department.

The research type of the study in this report was qualitative and descriptive. The data were obtained from primary data which was taken from a semi-structured interview with a human resource representative at Alkaram. The interview questions related to the process were about recruitment, employee turnover, strategies related to retention, effects of stakeholders on the HR decision-making, hiring costs, and employee satisfaction level. Further information was received from secondary sources in this report, such as books, research articles and Academic journals, to support the findings.

The study provides this information about the way in which recruitment processes are carried out to which Alkaram adheres to, involving job requisition, preparing job-description, advertising, short listing, interviewing, testing, reference check, offer letter and onboarding. The company, however, has a hard time in identifying and attracting qualified and competent individuals, in facing delays in the recruitment process, and in being able to match the other companies that can reel out a big salary. Turnover of employees is also a significant and important problem as they leave the job due to favourable offers, lack of promotion or work-life balance problems during busy periods in the business.

The results also identified certain stakeholders that influence HR decision making in Alkaram which include upper management, departmental heads, finance team, and business owners. The various priorities set by these stakeholders can result in the postponement of recruitment process and other HR decision making. Furthermore, recruitment comes with additional expenses such as advertising, interviewing, assessment, checking background records, medical examinations, onboarding, training sessions, etc.

The recommendations of this study to the Alkaram organization include providing competitive salaries, job promotion within the organization, reducing the time of recruitment procedures and their approval, improving communication with stakeholders, and providing job offers through employee referrals, and finally, improving work-life balance in the organization during busy periods. Staff feedback should be sought and employee engagement activities and recognition should continue to be enhanced as well.

Overall, the study gives the conclusion that effective Human Resource practices can help Alkaram to minimize employee turnover, control hiring major costs, enhance employee satisfaction level, and obtain better organizational performance.

Keywords: HR practices, recruitment and selection, employee turnover, employee satisfaction, hiring costs, stakeholder influence, Alkaram.

1 Introduction

Human resources are the most valuable resources of any organization since they add their skills, strength of knowledge and also their efforts to attain organization objectives. HR practices such as recruitment and selection, training and development, performance management, rewards and employee engagement are important to help any firm attract competent and qualified employees, improve and extend production and lower the rate of employee turnover (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014).

Alkaram is one of the renowned and reputed companies of the textile sector in Pakistan. Like most businesses, Alkaram has a lot of challenges related to HR, which include finding skilled staff, delayed recruitment processes,

employee turnover, costs of hiring, and employees' satisfaction level. Some members of staff wish to exit the organisation due to a better job offer from a competitor for salary, job opportunity and/or better work-life balance. Besides this, there can be variations in priorities between the senior management, finance, department heads and the business owners, which can delay HR decisions.

For understanding these issues this report and research will take into account an interview with a human resources officer at Alkaram. The interview also provides details on how the company ensures that they have processes in place to ensure that they don't lose employees and how they reduce the employee turnover rate, the influence of the stakeholders in HR decision making, the cost of hiring and how they work to improve the employee's satisfaction. The HR representative said that they hire through social media, online job portals, referral from employees and recruitment agencies. The company also utilises exit interviews, training initiatives, Bonuses based on performance, Career Development, and employee engagement initiatives to keep employees.

The important aspect of this study and report is to analyze the Human Resource practices at Alkaram, with the identification of the difficulties and problems faced by the Human Resource department, and recommend practical implementations. Only recruitment issues, employee turnover rate, impact of stakeholder, recruitment cost, and satisfaction of employees are discussed in this report and study. The findings of this research study can be used to improve the Human Resource system in Alkaram, reduce its recruitment delays and expenses, improve employee retention rate, and improve employee satisfaction.

1.1 Research Problem

Human resource management plays a crucial role in the success of an organization in the competitive textile and retail sector. The data gathered in this research, however, provide some indications that may present difficulties at Al-Karam, namely in obtaining skilled candidates, delays in receiving approval to recruit, difficulty in retaining workers and load during peak business activity. These problems can lead to higher recruitment costs and longer periods of time to hire someone and can impact employee satisfaction. But these challenges have not been quantified by HR data in this study to assess their extent and organizational impact. For this reason, this research aims to examine the HR practices reported by Al-Karam's HR representative, find the main challenges which were mentioned at the interview and discuss the practical consideration of improvement which could be suggested to the organization.

2. Literature Review

HR practices are the rules and actions that organizations use to recruit, train, motivate, evaluate, and retain employees. HR practices that are good enhance employee performance, job satisfaction level, and organizational productivity, while poor HR practices that are weak can make people leave and weaken business performance (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014).

2.1 Recruitment & Selection

Recruitment and selection are crucial activities in HR due to the impact they have on the quality of recruits. Organizations normally use recruitment through online portals, social media and social networking sites, referrals from existing employees, recruitment agencies, and campus recruitment in their recruiting efforts. However, recruitment becomes difficult where there are no suitable candidates, competing organizations give high salaries, there are slow approvals, or where organizations urgently require staff at particular periods (Karthik & Singh, 2025a; Rasool et al., 2021a). The situation is not different in Alkaram where HR encounters challenges in recruiting suitable individuals and recruiting them on time.

2.2 Employee Turnover

The second HR problem faced by organizations is employee turnover. Employees quit their jobs due to low salary, lack of career growth, work-life balance, recognition or even when they see better career opportunities outside their organization (Tett & Meyer, 1993). Research proves that career development, training, rewards, and job satisfaction reduce the urge to leave the organization and retain the employees (Setyagraha & Firdaus, n.d.-a 2025). Alkaram tries to minimize turnover problems by conducting exit interviews, training, rewarding based on performance, career development, and engaging the employees. But employees can leave due to better salary or career growth in other companies.

2.3 Stakeholder influence

HR decisions are also affected by stakeholders such as upper management, departmental heads, finance teams, and business owners. These stakeholders may have priorities; for example, managers or leaders may need employees on urgent basis, while finance team may delay the hiring process due to budget kind of restrictions. Such kinds of differences can slow down HR decision-making and create communication problems. Effective coordination, communication and clear approval procedures are therefore necessary for timely HR decision-making (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014).

2.4 Hiring costs

Hiring expenses include items such as advertisement, panel interview, assessment test, background verification test, health checkup, orientation, and training. The hiring expense is usually more in case of managerial and specialized jobs. Organizations can reduce their hiring expenses by making use of employee referral, internal promotion, candidate database management, and campus recruitment process (Karthik & Singh, 2025b). Alkaram makes use of all these processes to cut down time and recruitment expenses.

2.5 Employee Satisfaction

Finally, now, employee satisfaction has a lot to do with giving them proper compensation, supportive leadership, job security, opportunities to develop their skills, recognition, a safe and pleasant work environment, and balancing work and life. A satisfied employee will be more productive, supportive, and stay in the organization (Tahir Iqbal, 2026). Employee feedback from Alkaram is gathered via surveys, performance appraisals, and talks with supervisors in order to increase satisfaction.

Thus, the above-mentioned literature review reveals how effective recruitment systems, rewarding practices, training, career development, coordination of stakeholders and employees can help organizations solve HR problems. The current study uses these principles for the analysis of Alkaram.

3. Project Approach and Information Sources

This is a practice-focused capstone project rather than a broad empirical research study. The work was organized around a semi-structured interview with one HR representative at Al-Karam and a review of secondary literature relevant to the five project themes. The interview format allowed the same core topics to be covered while giving the participant room to explain processes and challenges.

3.1 Primary Information

The interview addressed recruitment stages and difficulties, employee turnover and retention strategies, stakeholder involvement in HR decisions, hiring costs, and employee satisfaction. The participant’s identity is not disclosed in this report. The findings are presented as information reported during the interview; they should not be interpreted as independently verified company statistics.

3.2 Secondary Documents Reviewed

The secondary-source review used the following books and academic works listed in the project's references. These sources were used for conceptual context, not as evidence that Al-Karam follows any particular policy:

- (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014), Armstrong's Handbook of Human Resource Management Practice.
- (McLeod, n.d.), guidance on thematic analysis.
- (Hom et al., 2017), review of employee-turnover theory and research.
- (Michael Galanakis & Giannis Peramatzis, 2022), Motivation to Work.
- (Korstjens & Moser, 2017), guidance on qualitative data collection and analysis.
- (Rasool et al., 2021b), work on workplace environment, organizational support, and employee wellbeing.
- (Saks, 2006a), research on antecedents and consequences of employee engagement.
- (Wright et al., 2005a), research on HR practices and firm performance.

3.3 Analysis of Interview Information

The interview information was grouped by topic to identify recurring patterns. The main categories were recruitment process and barriers, retention practices and turnover drivers, stakeholder coordination, recruitment-cost components and cost-control methods, and employee satisfaction. The resulting themes are summarized in the findings section. Because only one HR representative was interviewed, the analysis is descriptive and does not establish how frequently each issue occurs across the organization.

4. Results and Analysis

The results of this study are based on an interview with an HR representative at Alkaram. The purpose of the interview was to understand how the company manages its human resources and the challenges it faces in its daily operations. The findings are divided into five main areas: recruitment and selection, employee turnover and retention, stakeholder influence on HR decisions, hiring costs, and employee satisfaction. These findings are discussed in relation to the existing literature to identify areas of agreement and differences.

4.1 Recruitment Process and Difficulties

The recruitment process of Alkaram starts when a particular department recognizes the need for an additional employee. This need is conveyed to HR, which analyses the requirement and writes a job description. The position is advertised through different channels, such as online job sites, social media platforms, internal references, and recruiting agencies. After receiving applications, the HR team reviews them and shortlists applicants based on job requirements. Interviews are then conducted along with other tests in case of certain positions. Before making a final decision, reference checks are performed. The selected candidates get an offer letter, and upon acceptance of the offer, they join the organization through a joining and orientation process. From these observations, it can be concluded that the recruitment process of Alkaram is quite systematic. This is in line with (Rasool et al., 2021a)

, which stresses the significance of recruitment and selection in acquiring suitable candidates. Although there is a system in place, Alkaram faces various problems in recruitment process. According to the HR representative, the problem of recruiting suitable candidates is quite common. Another issue is salary competition, as some candidates decline job offers when other companies offer better compensation packages. Delays in obtaining approval from different departments can also slow down recruitment. These difficulties become more noticeable during busy production periods when employees are needed urgently.

These findings are similar to the challenges discussed in the existing literature, particularly skill shortages, competition for qualified candidates, and delays in recruitment decisions (Rasool et al., 2021a).

To address these issues, Alkaram could improve workforce planning, simplify its approval procedures, and review its salary packages to remain competitive in the job market.

4.2 Employee Turnover and Retention

The interview revealed that employee retention is an important aspect of the HR strategy of Alkaram. The HR representative said that the company has exit interviews to learn about employees' job turnover. The information gathered from these interviews can be used to identify issues and bring about changes in the workplace policies and practices of HR. The company also has a number of strategies in place to keep people on board. They involve training and development, learning, reward for performance, career development, employees' engagement activities and good performance recognition. Frequent meetings can also be used to see what issues employees might have and how to make their work experience better. But none of these measures will stop employees from walking off the job. Some of the staff members leave for other firms because they get higher salary offers or feel that they will do better in other firms, the HR representative said. It's also a consideration with work-life balance during the busiest periods of business when employees might have to take on heavier workloads. The results support the research indicating that training, career development, rewards and job satisfaction can be a factor in employee retention (Setyagraha & Firdaus, n.d.-b). Also, (tahir iqbal, 2026) speaks about HR practices in order to increase job satisfaction and decrease the intention to leave among employees. Currently, several retention strategies are being used by Alkaram, but the results indicate there is room for improvement. The company might look at their pay structure, offer more obvious promotion opportunities and share their workloads more evenly when there is a lot of work to be done. These actions can make employees feel more appreciated and keep them in the company.

4.3 Stakeholder Influence on HR Decisions

The HR representative said that there are multiple stakeholders who affect HR decisions at Alkaram such as the senior management, department heads, finance and business owners. These groups have different priorities and responsibilities and can sometimes cause problems in decision making. For instance, the finance department might need to have a handle on expenditure before agreeing to a new hire to a department manager, who might be looking for more workers to fulfil production targets. When there are mismatches in these priorities, HR initiatives such as recruitment can be delayed. Communication between departments was also mentioned as an important aspect of the interview. The sharing of information and understanding of stakeholders' needs makes it easier to make timely decisions. The results align with (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014) who highlight the need for HR to coordinate with other aspects of the organisation. Poor communication or when departments have conflicting priorities, HR decision making can be delayed and organizational effectiveness can be impacted. In order to enhance this situation, Alkaram may implement a streamlined recruitment approval process and set up a definition of each stakeholder's responsibilities. Frequent interaction among HR, finance and department heads could also aid companies to meet staffing needs and budget.

4.4 Hiring Costs

The interview revealed that there are a number of expenses when it comes to recruitment for Alkaram. These include posting job openings, conducting interviews, assessment testing, checking references, scheduling medical exams, and orientating and training new hires. A representative in the HR said that for managerial and specialized roles, the recruitment process can be more costly as they typically take a longer time to get right. Alkaram is trying to manage these costs in various ways in order to recruit. Employee referrals enable the company to identify possible candidates and promotions are available for regular staff who have the skills that the company requires. The company also

conducts campus recruitment activities and keeps a record of the candidates who could be suitable for the future job openings. These practices align with the literature, which suggests that recruitment can be a time-consuming and expensive process, especially when hiring someone with specialized expertise for a job (Karthik & Singh, 2025a). Additionally, Armstrong & Taylor, (2014) talk about the value of staffing through internal recruitment and other strategies in resourceful recruitment. But Alkaram could help its cost management by regularly checking on its recruitment performance. For instance HR could work out the cost of hiring individual employees, establish the length of unfilled vacancies, review the percentage of job offers accepted and/or review the percentage of new hires that depart within their first year. This would enable the business to determine which recruitment strategies yield the best outcome and what areas can be cut back to avoid unnecessary costs.

4.5 Employee Satisfaction

Employee satisfaction was another important subject that was discussed during the interview. Retaining employees who are satisfied with their jobs, the HR representative explained, is likely to be associated with their increased level of motivation to carry out their duties and their lower likelihood of leaving the company. Alkaram gathers feedback from employees through surveys, performance reviews, and with their supervisors to gain insight into their experiences. The company pays attention to a number of aspects which could contribute to making the job more satisfying, including competitive salaries, training etc, recognition, safe working circumstances and career development. It is also advisable for managers to keep the channels of communication open with employees for problems to be discussed and solved. The HR representative said that fair compensation, supportive management, job security, work-life balance, and professional development is a primary concern to the employees. From literature, it is found that there are factors affecting job satisfaction and employee turnover, such as compensation, recognition, training, and career opportunities, which are in line with the results of this study. But during the busy time of business, work-life balance is still a concern, too, according to the interview.

So, giving training and recognition might not be sufficient to keep employees happy. Alkaram also needs to take into account the load, staffing and the support given to employees during times of stress. This more evenhanded approach might help to develop a more positive working environment and enhance the employee experience.

4.6 Thematic Coding Table

Theme	Interview information reported	Implication for HR
Recruitment & selection	Formal stages are used, but skills shortages, competing offers, and approval delays can slow hiring.	Plan staffing earlier and clarify approval steps.
Retention	Training, rewards, career development, engagement, and exit interviews are used; salary and career concerns remain.	Use exit feedback to target compensation, growth, and retention actions.
Stakeholder coordination	Senior management, finance, and department heads influence hiring decisions and may have competing priorities.	Define responsibilities, timelines, and regular workforce-planning discussions.
Hiring costs	Costs include advertising, assessments, checks, onboarding, and training; referrals and internal promotion are used.	Track cost per hire and recruitment outcomes by sourcing channel.
Employee satisfaction	Feedback is gathered through surveys, reviews, and meetings; peak-period workload is a concern.	Respond to feedback and plan staffing and workloads more carefully.

5. Discussion

The findings of the interviews are discussed with regard to the research objectives of the study and the literature. It looks at the way that Alkaram carries out recruitment and selection, employee attrition, employee satisfaction, employee cost, and how they involve stakeholders. The discussion also does so by taking into account the company's existing HR practices and pinpoints where improvements may be beneficial, based on the previous research.

Results show that the recruitment process of Alkaram is directed and starts from a request for staffing by the respective department, followed by the candidate's joining and orientation. HR will go through the job requirements, prepare a job description, advertise the job, shortlist, interview, and run the checks required before they make an offer. This is in line with the past research which emphasizes the need for proper recruitment and selection of individuals that are appropriate for the job offered (Poropat, n.d.). (Huselid, n.d. A good recruitment process can assist organisations in hiring individuals with the requisite skill and experience to complete a role. The interview also revealed that Alkaram is struggling to recruit candidates to its workforce because they are lacking in the necessary skills and experience. Recruitment can be tough during busy production times such as salary competition or delays in internal approvals. These results are similar to other studies, such as Rasool et al. (2021a), who noted that recruiting is difficult. They also conclude that a formal recruiting system is not an indication that all vacancies will be filled immediately. Other factors that reduce the success of recruitment include a lack of qualified candidates, compensation packages that are hard to match, and slow internal decision-making. (Huselid, n.d.-a)

In the case of Alkaram, the ability to identify staffing needs earlier could be achieved through better workforce planning. Other advantages, such as quicker approvals and more competitive compensation offered, also make it easier to find the right candidates. Furthermore, competency-based interviews and enhanced employer branding might facilitate the company's evaluation process, and they will, in the future, look better as a work environment. (Karthik & Singh, 2025b).

Results of interviews reveal that several practices are implemented by Alkaram to motivate their employees to stay with the company. They include training, rewards based on performance, career development, employee engagement activities and exit interviews. The practices show that the company is aware of the significance in keeping experienced workers instead of always recruiting replacements. This is in line with previous research (Huselid, n.d.-a) that looks at the link between HR practices, employee turnover and organizational performance. In the same way, (Arthur, n.d.) investigates the role that HR systems geared towards employee development and commitment can play in better employee outcomes. High performance work practices are also related to organizational performance, as discussed by Boxall & Macky (2009). All of this with little giving any sign that salary competitiveness, career paths, or work-life balance issues are any less of a factor in an employee's decision whether to leave Alkaram. This means that retention requires not the only HR programmes be available, but also that employees should believe that their needs and expectations are being met. (Mobley, n.d.). discusses the relationship between job dissatisfaction and employees' decisions to leave their jobs. Mitchell et al. (n.d.) also provide another explanation for decreased turnover: employees are less inclined to quit when they feel that they are deeply connected to their employer, are satisfied with the role, and feel they would miss out on valuable benefits or relationships if they left. The following ideas are relevant to Alkaram since employees are more likely to remain if they believe that there are real opportunities for advancement, have a fair compensation, and are supported by their manager. Allen et al., (n.d.) also stress the need to rely not only on general engagement strategies, but on suitable retention strategies as well.

From this data, Alkaram should investigate what are the reasons of employee's turnover and apply it to determine solutions. For instance, reviews of salaries might resolve compensation problems or more transparent promotion standards can make staffing more skilled about their future possibilities. If employer workload is planned better during peak seasons, it may also relieve the employees' stress.

The results indicate that the collaboration of multiple stakeholders plays a role in HR decisions made at Alkaram. The recruitment and staffing decisions are impacted by senior management and finance, department heads and business owners. Their priorities may be different, though. Finance may be more interested in keeping spending under control,

while department managers may be more interested in making production targets, and ensuring they have adequate staffing. This discovery underscores the significance of coordination in HR management (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014) that must be done to meet broader business goals and be cognizant of the needs and constraints of other departments. The results can also be used in the context of the resource based view of the firm. Human resources and HR practices are important for the competitive advantage as discussed by (Wright et al., 2005b). When suitable employees aren't available when required, the company could suffer from staffing deficits that will impact productivity and business operations, if Alkaram can't recruit them. The problem isn't only that there are multiple parties involved in HR decisions. They have to participate, but the process must be handled in an efficient manner. Alkaram could tackle this by defining who do they approve the vacancies and approving them with a realistic deadline and discussing the requirement of workforce before peak production periods. The regular planning of manpower between HR and finance and heads of the departments can also help to meet the demand of manpower and budget requirements.

The results show that there are several costs to be faced by Alkaram in recruiting new employees. These include advertisement, interview, testing, background checks, medical examination, induction and training. There might be a higher cost for specialized skills or senior-level job positions, as they may be more difficult to fill. These results are in line with the literature that found recruitment and employee replacement are among the significant organizational costs (Hom et al., 2017). Turning over employees shortly after their recruitment can lead to the company having to go through all of the recruitment and training again, resulting in further costs (Armstrong & Taylor, 2014). Alkaram has already implemented employee referrals, internal promotions, campus recruitment and candidate databases to control the hiring costs. These techniques can enable the company to reach out to prospective candidates via a variety of avenues, and minimize reliance on higher-cost recruitment strategies. The effectiveness of the above methods should be determined from real recruitment data, however. For example, cost-per-hire can show the average expense of recruiting an employee, while time to-fill measures how long it takes to fill a vacancy. Offer-acceptance rates can help HR understand whether its job offers appeal to candidates, and early turnover rates can indicate whether newly recruited employees are staying with the company. By monitoring these indicators, Alkaram could identify the recruitment channels that produce suitable employees at a reasonable cost. This would allow HR to make better-informed decisions about recruitment spending (Hom et al., 2017; Karthik & Singh, 2025b).

The results indicated that the efforts made by Alkaram to ensure employee satisfaction are through compensation, training and development, recognition, safety conditions, career development and communication between employees and managers. These practices align with the research on job satisfaction and workplace factors, which identifies pay, recognition, management support, and opportunities for professional growth as key factors in the workplace (Hasan et al., 2024), and also examine the relationship between job satisfaction and employee performance (Herzberg et al., 2017), which emphasizes the significance of achievement, recognition, responsibility, and growth in employee motivation. These are additional ways of understanding employee engagement. Saks (2006b) explores how organizational support, job characteristics, and rewards affects employee engagement and what meaningful work, psychological safety and resources are in this regard.

These ideas indicate that the work of Alkaram's training, recognition and career work may contribute to the feeling of the employees in their work. But the interview also sheds light on the challenges that workers face during busy times of the year. Of course, this is a significant factor, as an employee may enjoy the privileges that the company provides, but feels discontented if the workload is too heavy or they cannot manage work and personal commitments. By making these predictions and planning for staffing needs earlier, hiring temporary personnel during peak times, and creating equal workloads, Alkaram may therefore increase customer satisfaction.

Based on the interview results, Alkaram's HR practices can help to enhance organizational performance in multiple ways. Skills are recruited, training is provided to develop the skills of the company's employees, rewards are given to motivate employees to perform well, and engagement activities can be conducted to boost retention. These results are similar to the results of previous studies that investigated the link between HR practices and organizational outcomes. The impact of HR practices on productivity and turnover, such as selective hiring, employee training, performance-based remuneration, and employee involvement, are discussed in (Huselid, 1995) while (Wright et al., 2005b) study the link between HR practices and firm performance. The results indicate that HR practices can't be taken out of context. For instance, recruitment can enable the organisation to have the skilled employees, however, they require to

be trained accordingly. Rewards can also motivate employees to contribute to organizational objectives, but ineffective management and inadequate career paths may still cause them to not be satisfied. For Alkaram, the key is for recruitment, training, performance management, rewards and employee engagement to work together. By taking an integrated approach, the company can leverage the existing workforce to tackle some of the issues that they have been identified in the interview. This study however was conducted by interviewing an HR representative and hence the results should be taken with a pinch of salt. They show insight into the HR practices that the company reports 10 but are not direct evidence of the effectiveness of these practices on the company's performance.

The results reveal that Alkaram is trying to provide support for employees through training, recognition, communication, and career development. These behaviors can make workers believe the business cares about them and their career development and well-being. Employees' attitudes toward their employer can be affected by the way they feel they are treated so organizational support is important. If employees feel valued and supported, they might feel a greater sense of belonging to the organization and be more likely to stay. Organizational commitment can also be used to account for the reasons why employees remain with an organization. Affective commitment is the desire to remain with the organization, continuance commitment is based on the cost of leaving, and normative commitment is based on an obligation to remain. Alkaram's organizational support may be increased by offering compensation that is fair, acknowledging employee work, offering realistic career progression and providing managers with feedback on employee concerns. These measures can be especially useful when it comes to the busiest periods in business when there's the possibility of extra stress being put on the employees. The results also indicate that employee support should go beyond formal HR programs. Managerial communication, work distribution, and problem solving can affect employee's work experiences. Hence, it is recommended that the working environment for the employees at Alkaram should be designed so that workers would feel appreciated, supported and would have opportunities to voice concerns.

6. Conclusion

This study investigated the HR practices in Alkaram, which were recruitment & selection, employee turnover, influence of stakeholders in HR decision-making, recruitment expenses, and employee satisfaction. The research methodology was an interview with an HR representative and supplemented with data from the existing academic literature.

The results indicate that recruitment of Alkaram is systematic. If a department requires an employee it will make a request to HR who will write the job description, post the job, shortlist candidates, interview them and carry out the checks. The process offers a transparent way of filling vacancies throughout the organization. There were some problems, however, during the recruitment of the subjects of the interview. It can be difficult to find candidates who have the right skills and experience and, at times, candidates turn down offers because they are being offered a more attractive salary elsewhere. Approval issues involving managers, finance and department heads can also hinder the hiring process. On the other hand, these issues are more apparent when there are peak production periods requiring employees to be needed in a hurry. Another significant issue is employee retention. Alkaram’s retention strategies include training, rewards, career development, engagement activities and exit interviews. However, some of them depart due to a better offer from another company, lack of career progression or problems with balancing work and life during busy times. This indicates that the company should keep monitoring and adapting its retention strategies and meeting evolving employee expectations. Another finding of the study was that multiple stakeholders have an impact on HR decisions. While the engagement of management, finance and department heads is essential, their priorities may differ, which can lead to a delayed recruitment. Assigning clear responsibilities and improved communication may make for more efficient decision making. Another focus is on hiring costs. Alkaram invests in background checks, interviews, assessment, and orientation and training. The company already has several systems in place to control the costs of this business: referrals, promotion from within, campus recruiting and databases of candidates. If HR is able to track the results of hiring and recruitment expenses, he or she will be better equipped to determine which strategies are most successful. Lastly, the results show that Alkaram attempts to enhance employee

satisfaction by offering competitive wages and benefits, training, recognition, good working conditions and career advancement. But, during busy times this may impact on the employee's experience.

The study indicated that there are some HR practices implemented in the organization but it can be enhanced. Having more effective workforce planning, competitive compensation, clearer career paths, quicker recruitment approval, and improved workload management could help the company to address the challenges identified in the interview. These enhancements can lead to higher staff contentment and retention, and can enable HR to play a more effective role in meeting the goals of the organization.

6.1 Recommendations

Based on the interview findings and the discussion of existing literature, the following recommendations are proposed for Alkaram.

1. Review of salary packages. Alkaram should regularly compare its salary packages with those offered by other employers to attract qualified candidates and reduce turnover caused by compensation differences.

2. Provide clear career opportunities. The company should establish clearer promotion criteria and career development plans so employees can understand how they can progress within the organization.

3. Improve workforce planning. HR should work with department heads to identify staffing requirements in advance, particularly before peak production seasons, to reduce last-minute recruitment pressure.

4. Reduce approval delays. Alkaram should clarify recruitment approval responsibilities and improve coordination between HR, finance, senior management, and department heads.

5. Continue cost-effective recruitment. Employee referrals, internal promotions, campus recruitment, and candidate databases should remain part of the recruitment strategy, with their effectiveness reviewed regularly.

6. Expand employee training. The company should provide training based on employees' job requirements and development needs to improve their skills, confidence, and performance.

7. Improve work-life balance. During busy periods, Alkaram should consider temporary staffing, fair workload distribution, and other practical measures to reduce excessive pressure on employees.

8. Strengthen recognition programs. Managers should acknowledge employees' contributions and good performance to help maintain motivation and a positive working environment.

9. Act on employee feedback. HR should regularly collect feedback through surveys, meetings, and exit interviews and communicate the actions taken in response to employees' concerns.

10. Develop management communication skills. Managers should be encouraged to communicate openly, provide constructive feedback, and respond to employee concerns in a fair and timely manner

7. References

Allen, D. G., Bryant, P. C., & Vardaman, J. M. (n.d.). *Retaining Talent: Replacing Misconceptions With Evidence-Based Strategies*.

Armstrong, M., & Taylor, S. (2014). *Armstrong's handbook of human resource management practice* (13th Edition). Kogan Page Ltd.

Arthur, J. B. (n.d.). *EFFECTS OF HUMAN RESOURCE SYSTEMS ON MANUFACTURING PERFORMANCE AND TURNOVER*.

Hasan, J., Hasan, M., Rahman, A., & Hossain, U. (n.d.). 14_Job Satisfaction Theories A Literature Review. *Technology. Vol. 8*.

Herzberg, F., Mausner, B., & Snyderman, B. B. (2017). *Motivation to work*. Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315124827

Hom, P. W., Lee, T. W., Shaw, J. D., & Hausknecht, J. P. (2017). One hundred years of employee turnover theory and research. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, *102*(3), 530–545. https://doi.org/10.1037/apl0000103

Huselid, M. A. (n.d.-a). ^ *THE IMPACT OF HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PRACTICES ON TURNOVER, PRODUCTIVITY, AND CORPORATE FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE*.

Huselid, M. A. (n.d.-b). *THE IMPACT OF HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PRACTICES ON TURNOVER, PRODUCTIVITY, AND CORPORATE FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE*.

Kahn, W. A. (1990). PSYCHOLOGICAL CONDITIONS OF PERSONAL ENGAGEMENT AND DISENGAGEMENT AT WORK. *Academy of Management Journal*, *33*(4), 692–724. https://doi.org/10.2307/256287

Karthik, M. S., & Singh, D. K. S. (2025a). *The Impact of Effective Recruitment and Selection Practices on Organizational Performance*. *12*(5).

Karthik, M. S., & Singh, D. K. S. (2025b). *The Impact of Effective Recruitment and Selection Practices on Organizational Performance*. *12*(5).

Korstjens, I., & Moser, A. (2017). Series: Practical guidance to qualitative research. Part 2: Context, research questions and designs. *European Journal of General Practice*, *23*(1), 274–279. https://doi.org/10.1080/13814788.2017.1375090

McLeod, S. (n.d.). *Thematic Analysis: A Step-by-Step Guide*.

Michael Galanakis & Giannis Peramatzis. (2022). Herzberg's Motivation Theory in Workplace. *Journal of Psychology Research*, *12*(12). https://doi.org/10.17265/2159-5542/2022.12.009

Mitchell, T. R., Holtom, B. C., Lee, T. W., Sablynski, C. J., & Erez, M. (n.d.). *WHY PEOPLE STAY: USING JOB EMBEDDEDNESS TO PREDICT VOLUNTARY TURNOVER*.

Mobley, W. H. (n.d.). *Intermediate Linkages in the Relationship Between Job Satisfaction and Employee Turnover*.

Poropat, A. (n.d.). *New Models of Work Performance and their implications for Employment Relations*.

Rasool, S. F., Wang, M., Tang, M., Saeed, A., & Iqbal, J. (2021a). How Toxic Workplace Environment Effects the Employee Engagement: The Mediating Role of Organizational Support and Employee Wellbeing. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, *18*(5), 2294. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph18052294

Rasool, S. F., Wang, M., Tang, M., Saeed, A., & Iqbal, J. (2021b). How Toxic Workplace Environment Effects the Employee Engagement: The Mediating Role of Organizational Support and Employee Wellbeing. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, *18*(5), 2294. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph18052294

Saks, A. M. (2006a). Antecedents and consequences of employee engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology*, *21*(7), 600–619. https://doi.org/10.1108/02683940610690169

Saks, A. M. (2006b). Antecedents and consequences of employee engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology*, *21*(7), 600–619. https://doi.org/10.1108/02683940610690169

Setyagraha, J. A., & Firdaus, V. (n.d.-a). *The Influence of Motivation Strategy, Rewards, Training and Career Development on Employee Retention Through Job Satisfaction as an Intervening Variable at PT. Manggalakarya Bangun Sarana*.

Setyagraha, J. A., & Firdaus, V. (n.d.-b). *The Influence of Motivation Strategy, Rewards, Training and Career Development on Employee Retention Through Job Satisfaction as an Intervening Variable at PT. Manggalakarya Bangun Sarana*.

Tahir Iqbal, Hayatullah. (2026). HR Practices and Employee Turnover Intention: The Mediating Role of Job Satisfaction and Moderating Role of Perceived Organizational Support in Afghanistan's Banking Sector. *Vol. 5 No. 01 Jan-March 2026*, *5*(1), 11. https://assajournal.com/index.php/36/article/view/1637

Tett, R. P., & Meyer, J. P. (1993). JOB SATISFACTION, ORGANIZATIONAL COMMITMENT, TURNOVER INTENTION, AND TURNOVER: PATH ANALYSES BASED ON META-ANALYTIC FINDINGS. *Personnel Psychology*, *46*(2), 259–293. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.1993.tb00874.x

Wright, P. M., Gardner, T. M., Moynihan, L. M., & Allen, M. R. (2005a). THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN HR PRACTICES AND FIRM PERFORMANCE: EXAMINING CAUSAL ORDER. *Personnel Psychology*, *58*(2), 409–446. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2005.00487.x

Wright, P. M., Gardner, T. M., Moynihan, L. M., & Allen, M. R. (2005b). THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN HR PRACTICES AND FIRM PERFORMANCE: EXAMINING CAUSAL ORDER. *Personnel Psychology*, *58*(2), 409–446. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2005.00487.x

Zeenat, Z., & Sharma, D. A. (n.d.). *"Impact of Compensation on Employee Satisfaction and Employee Retention in Universities."*